2026

Tesco Ornamental Plant Standard

Version 5.0

SERVING OUR CUSTOMERS, COMMUNITIES AND PLANET A LITTLE BETTER EVERYDAY

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In the event of any inconsistency, ambiguity, or conflict between versions of this policy and any translated version, the English language version shall prevail. Suppliers acknowledge and agree that the English version constitutes the sole official and legally binding text, and that any translations are provided solely for convenience and shall not be relied upon for interpretative or contractual purposes.

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Introduction

Welcome to version 5.0 of the Tesco Ornamental Plant Standard.

This Standard has been developed to outline the requirements to which packers of Horticulture and Ornamental plant products must comply in order to begin supplying, and thereafter continue supplying Tesco, either directly or indirectly.

The Standard continues to support Tesco's commitment to maintaining trust in the Tesco brand and supply chain, by ensuring all own-brand products are safe, meet legal requirements, and always meet customer expectations with respect to quality, origin and responsible sourcing.

Tesco Standards are intended to be applied in a way that manages risk and grows capability.

They are to be interpreted globally, and to encourage sites to demonstrate compliance as appropriate to them and their industry, and proportional to the risks of their products, their processes and their site environment.

Full application of the standard will support packers in driving improvement, reduction in non-conforming products, and therefore help to reduce waste and cost.

Tesco does not endorse any equipment manufacturer or service provider (other than contracted Audit Service Providers or Approved Nominated Experts).
Any equipment manufacturer or other service provider claiming to be endorsed by Tesco should be reported to your Tesco contact.
It remains the responsibility of the supplier/site to risk assess the integrity of equipment or services in terms of compliance to our standards, modules and requirements.

Purpose & Scope

This Standard is applicable to all sites which supply Tesco Horticulture products. The Standard can also be applied to any packing operation supplying Tesco at any stage of the supply chain.

If you are in doubt as to whether your site is within the scope of this standard, please discuss it with your Tesco Technical contact.

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Clause Scope Definitions

This document contains the three main Modules: Core, Supplier Assurance and Product Assurance.

There are also product/process specific modules that may also apply.

Having these modules allows our requirements to be flexible and tailored to the wide range of products and processes in our supply chains, making it really clear to sites which requirements are applicable.
A modular approach allows us to respond proactively to emerging risks, updating them and developing new ones when required.

Core

These requirements apply to all sites supplying Tesco Horticulture. Within Core, 'Environment, water and waste management' may be omitted from a site's Maintenance audit if valid certification to ISO 14001 is held, and the 'Responsible Sourcing' section may be omitted from a maintenance audit where the supplier can demonstrate they meet the requirements outlined in the relevant Tesco Policy, relating to either third-party ethical certification, e.g. SMETA, SIZA, or reduced ethical audit frequency.

Supplier Assurance

These requirements relate to supplier and site standards.

Product Assurance

These requirements relate to product standards.

Additional Modules

Sites are required to be aware of and comply with the further Modules that apply to their products and processes. These Modules are available on the Tesco due diligence platform and listed in document *80576 - Technical Documents Register*, which can be found on the Tesco due diligence platform (currently TQC - *https://qualityconnect.tesco.com/orbcprod/login.vm*), and contains a list of all Modules. The applicable Modules will be assessed along with the requirements in this document, as part of a site's Tesco audit, and the assessment will contribute to the site's audit result.

Under no circumstance does adherence to this standard or any separate Module, or 'Tesco Requirements for Suppliers', replace the need for compliance to relevant legal standards in the country of manufacture/packing or the intended country of sale.

If you have any questions on the application of this Standard or Modules please contact your Tesco Technical contact. If you have any questions on the content of the Standard please contact the Tesco Standards and Audit team at TechnicalAuditQueries@tesco.com.

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Inclusion of ISO

In order to ensure we continue to drive improvement and add value for our suppliers and customers through our non-food offer we need to identify new and innovative ways of monitoring compliance to our requirements within our supplier base.

We therefore recognise ISO 14001:2015 as part of the ornamental plant maintenance audit programme; it is important to note that approval audits will still be to the full standard.

If a site does not have ISO certification or has an ISO certification that does not meet our criteria the full standard will be applied during the maintenance audit.

ISO 14001:2015 Criteria

The criteria a site must meet in order to incorporate ISO 14001 as part of the audit are:

- The ISO 14001 certificate must be valid at the time of the Tesco audit.
    - If the certification is due to be renewed details of the upcoming 14001 audit must be noted on TQC
- The ISO 14001 certificate must have been awarded through one of our recognised accredited certification bodies
- The validity of the certification must be checked using the online directory of the relevant accreditation body by the Tesco Standards & Audit team.
- The ISO 14001 certificate must include all customer requirements in the scope.
- The ISO 14001 certificate, audit report and close out report must be available on TQC

If a site meets all of the criteria for ISO 14001 the following section of the standard is substituted:

Section 4 Environment, water and waste management

It is important to note that all sections will still be available to the Tesco auditor if a Critical issue is identified relating to the section.

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Auditing of Standard

Tesco and its representatives will undertake audits of packers, against this Standard and the relevant audit Modules, to determine the level of compliance. Further information on the Tesco audit process can be found in document *60348 – Technical audit process for suppliers*. This can be found on the Tesco due diligence platform or obtained from your Tesco Technical contact.

There is the potential for non-conformances to be raised through the audit and these will be categorised as:

Critical

A critical non-conformance is identified where there is a significant failure to meet a product safety, legal or quality requirement.
The failure will have an immediate and direct adverse effect on Tesco's brand reputation (or that of the customer).
A critical non-conformance scenario would include.
- the production or supply of out of specification product
- an accumulation of major non-conformances which are inter-related
- an isolated incident/issue which is a significant product safety, legal or quality issue
- a systematic failure

Major

A major non-conformance is identified where there is a serious failure to meet a product safety, legal or quality requirement. The
failure will not result in an overall systematic failure in risk management but will result in the production or supply of product
which has the **potential for an adverse effect** on Tesco's brand reputation (or that of the customer).

A major non-conformance scenario would include.
- an accumulation of minor non-conformances which are inter-related
- an isolated incident/issue which is a serious product safety, legal or quality issue
- a reoccurring ineffective control

Footnote: If the audit is for approval, then the failure is taken to represent the situation if a Tesco product were being handled. A
critical or major non-conformance may be identified against a Standard (clause, section), Module, Policy, Requirement,
Business Commitment or Operational Procedures.

Minor

A minor non-conformance is identified when there is a failure to meet a requirement but when the result has no direct or adverse
effect on product safety, legal compliance or brand reputation.

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The non-conformance may be identified against a Standard (clause), Module (clause), Policy, Requirement, Business
Commitment or Operational Procedure.

Recommendation

A recommendation may be identified where there is opportunity for continuous improvement or preventative measures.
Recommendations do not count towards the overall audit grade however must be addressed as part of the audit corrective
action plan.

Audit results

Depending on the category of non-conformances and numbers identified, factories will receive a specific rating according to the
table below.
The 'Suspended' rating reflects the most severe scenarios that for example, may be reportable to relevant authorities, following
review by Tesco. Auditors will not be able to award a Suspended rating; they will still only award an Unsatisfactory if finding a Critical non-conformance, or 4 or more Major non-conformances. Tesco will then review the non-conformances and decide if the
rating needs to be escalated from Unsatisfactory to Suspended. Examples of non-conformances resulting in a Suspended rating
are:

- safety or legality issue where our customers are at immediate riskDocument Reference & Title Page 7 of 15
- serious ethical breach such as evident child labour
- legislative breach

	Result/rating	Meaning	Non-conformances
Approval audit*	Approved	Approval Audit is successful	• 0 Critical non-conformances • 0 Major non-conformances • There is no limit on the number of Minor non-conformances
	Approval Pending	Approval audit is successful (pending close out of major non-conformances)	• 1-3 Major non-conformances
	Not Approved	Approval audit is unsuccessful	• 1 or more Critical non-conformances • 4 or more Major non-conformances • 35 or more total non-conformances where at least 2 are Majors
Ongoing maintenance audit	5	Very Good	• 0-5 Minor non-conformances only
		Satisfactory	• 6-12 Minor non-conformances only

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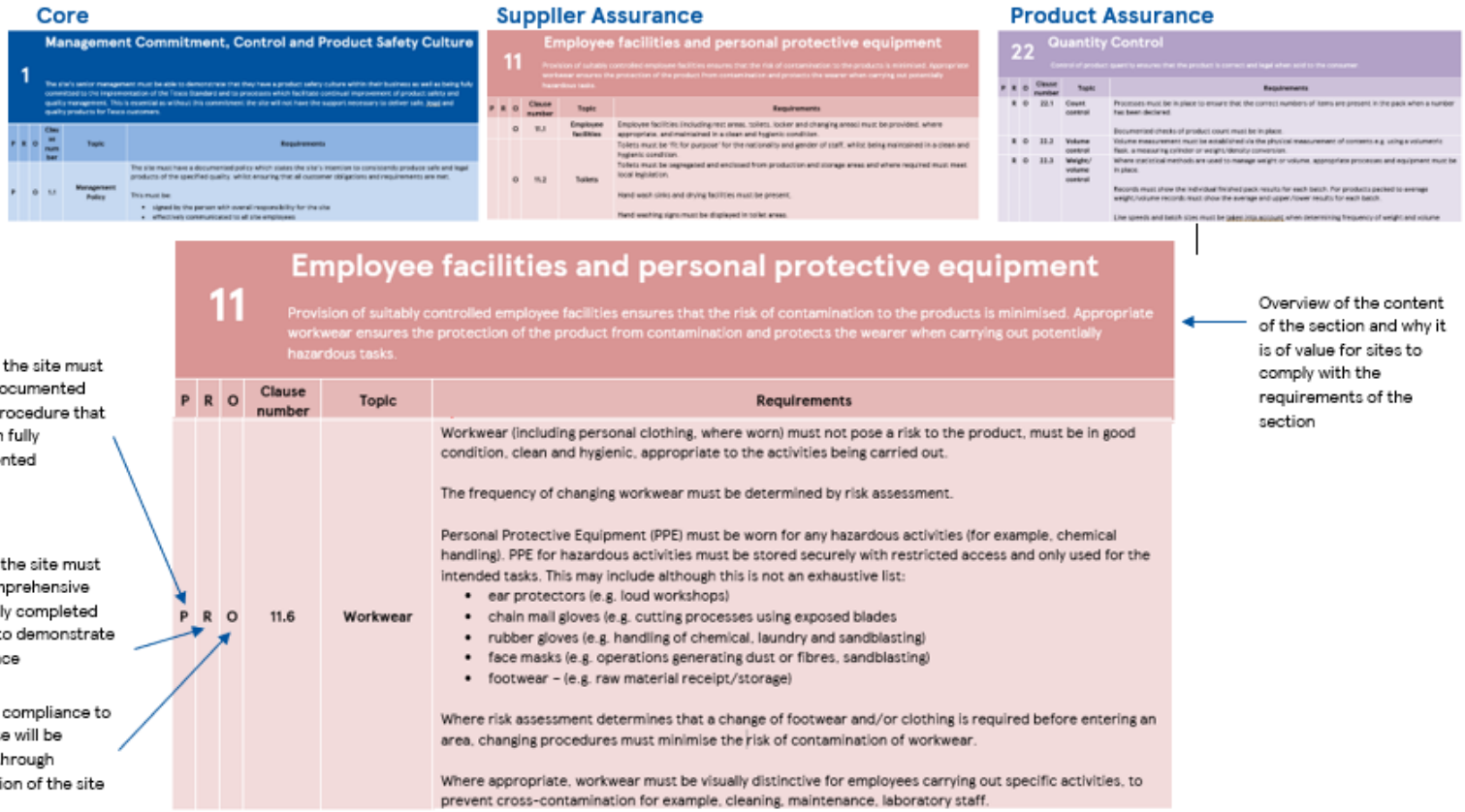
	4		
	3	Improvement needed	• 0 Critical non-conformances • 1 Major non-conformances (and/or) • 13-25 Minor non-conformances
	2	Poor	• 0 Critical non-conformances • 2-3 Major non-conformances (and/or) • 26-34 Minor non-conformances
	1	Unsatisfactory**	• 1 or more Critical non-conformances • 4 or more Major non-conformances • 35 or more total non-conformances
	0	Suspended	• 1 or more Critical non-conformances that may be reportable externally to a relevant authority

*An approval audit may be the first audit of a site prior to Tesco production, an audit to extend the scope (e.g. additional product type or new process) or may be a further audit of a previously not approved site.
**Sites that receive an 'Unsatisfactory' rating will need to immediately contact their Tesco Technical contact.

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Clause Layout

The diagram below describes how the Standard and clauses are laid out, and the purpose of different elements. The colour-coding reflects the Core, Supplier Assurance and Product Assurance requirements.



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Core Clauses

1 Leadership Accountability, control and product safety culture

The site's senior management must be able to demonstrate that they have a product safety culture within their business as well as being fully committed and accountable to the implementation of the Tesco Standard and to processes which facilitate continual improvement of product safety and quality management. This is essential as without this commitment the site will not have the support necessary to deliver safe, legal and quality products for Tesco customers

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P		O	1.1	Management policy	The site must have a documented policy which states the site's intention to consistently produce safe and legal products of the specified quality, whilst ensuring that all customer obligations and requirements are met. This must be: • signed by the person with overall accountability for the site • effectively communicated to all site employees • understood by employees to enable a positive safety and compliance culture and demonstrated through safe behaviours and understanding of risks and consequences
P		O	1.2	Organisational structure	A documented organisational structure chart must be in place showing management responsibilities and authority. Details of deputising cover for personnel with responsibility for legal, safety and quality issues must be documented.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		1.3	Management review	Site management must regularly review all activities that could affect the safety, legality and quality of product supplied to Tesco, or Tesco's reputation.
P	R		1.4	Resource	The site must have appropriate human and financial resources to produce safe and legal products at the right quality for Tesco, maintain good industry practices and meet the requirements of this Standard, and all relevant Tesco Modules and requirements. Meeting each requirement of this Standard is formally delegated and strategically planned to be adhered to during day-to-day activities.
	R	O	1.5	Capacity Planning	The site must plan and review its own performance in: • meeting peak production without exceeding capacity • balancing production processes to avoid bottlenecks • meeting product safety requirements • implementing effective systems of daily organisation to have people materials and equipment in the right place at the right time Having effective systems of review, such that planning issues are raised and resolved to prevent impact on performance.
P	R		1.6	Key performance indicators	The management team must measure key performance indicators and establish actions to improve performance, following regular analysis in key areas.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P		O	1.7	Communication	The site has an effective 'two-way' communication policy between management and staff. Expectations and requirements are communicated effectively and understanding of the requirements is assessed. Responses and suggestions from staff are encouraged, and adopted where relevant, to assist in achieving the requirements of this Standard.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		1.8	Notifying Tesco of incidents	The site must have effective systems in place to ensure that the relevant Tesco (or customer*) contact is notified as soon as possible of any issues that directly affect or may have the potential to affect: • Tesco product safety, legality, quality, or integrity • the site's ability to supply, or • Tesco reputation *for indirect, upstream and raw material suppliers, where relevant Where Tesco product is affected, the Tesco Technical contact must be involved in the final decision for handling the product. For example, Tesco must be informed following: • notification of potential or actual enforcement action, including product safety, health and safety, and environmental issues • judgements • activity involving NGO, union, trade association • police, immigration, GLAA, other such authority investigations • anonymous internal or external contact, e.g. 'whistle-blower' • low scoring/failed third-party audit e.g. GFSI, ethical, environmental • contact with the media • any similar activity relating to upstream supplier(s) to, retailer/customer/third party associates of, the site that may have actual/potential impact on Tesco.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	1.9	Representation during audit for Tesco	The most senior operational manager available on site at the time of the audit must participate in the opening and closing meetings. Other relevant representatives must be available as required during the audit.

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2 Quality Management System and site audits

Quality management of processes ensure that safe and legal products are consistently produced to the agreed specification and desired quality. This is fundamental in supporting the required due diligence of all processes. Auditing assesses the effectiveness of site procedures and policies in maintaining the safety, legality and quality of products. It supports the identification of the potential need for improvement.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	2.1	Quality management system	The site must have a Quality Management System (QMS), which is maintained, documented and regularly reviewed - annually as a minimum. There must be a site employee responsible for the management of the site Quality Management System. The site must identify and comply with all relevant audit Modules and Tesco Requirements for Suppliers (see 80576 - Technical Documents Register). The QMS must include documented procedures detailing the processes carried out to comply with the product safety, legality and quality requirements of this Standard, Modules and Tesco Requirements for Suppliers. The content of the QMS must be available to relevant employees and be integrated into day-to-day operations.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		2.2	Document control	All documents related to legality, quality and product safety must be adequately controlled, authorised and the correct versions must be in use. Alterations to records must be appropriately authorised and a change log maintained. All records must be accurate and fully complete. All documentation and records must be retained for a defined period with consideration given to: • any legal requirements (including product legislation) • the product vase/shelf life • specific Tesco requirements and Tesco primary Supplier requirements All documentation and records must be available for Tesco audit and demonstrate compliance with the product safety, legality and quality requirements of this Standard, Modules and other relevant Tesco requirements.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		2.3	Internal audits	Internal audits of the site's activities must verify whether they comply with procedures, policies and work instructions to ensure product safety, legality and quality are maintained. Internal audits covering all activities must be completed at a frequency defined by risk assessment, and annually as a minimum. Where the risk assessment determines that more than one audit is required, they must be scheduled to occur evenly throughout the operational periods. Audits must be completed to include night shifts, weekend working, seasonal activities and any out of hours activities. Auditors must be competent to carry out their activity, through training, work experience or qualification and have good knowledge of the processes and areas. When a site is part of a group of sites under a common Quality Management System, full internal audits must be conducted at each site. Internal audits must include an assessment of all site activities against this Tesco standard and the auditor must identify whether the site is compliant or not compliant during the audit.
	R		2.4	Corrective action	The site must have effective systems in place to ensure any corrective actions identified following management reviews, incidents, complaints, internal audits, other second party or third-party audits, are effective and implemented within timescales appropriate to the risks identified.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		2.5	Audit records	Records of all audits must include who was present, which activities, products, documents and/or site areas were audited. Records must include details of compliance, good practices, non-conformances and recommendations. All audit findings must be brought to the attention of the people responsible for the activities, products, documents and/or site areas audited.

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3 Responsible Sourcing

The requirements in this section are the minimum global requirement for Tesco. They are included in this Standard as it is commonly the case that a technical visit is the first stage of the Tesco site approval process.

This section may be omitted from a maintenance audit where the supplier can demonstrate they meet the requirements outlined in the relevant Tesco Policy, relating to either third-party ethical certification, e.g. SMETA, SIZA, or reduced ethical audit frequency

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P			3.1	Responsible Sourcing Requirements	The site must be aware of and have procedures in place to comply with the Responsible Sourcing requirements outlined in document 60585 Human Rights Requirements for Food and Grocery Non-Food Suppliers. These standards comprise of the ETI Base Code, local laws and regulations, as well as our own requirements on specific issues. The site must have a procedure in place to ensure they keep up to date with local laws and regulation, e.g. minimum wages, insurances, health and safety standards etc.
P	R	O	3.2	Whistle Blowing	As a minimum one independent whistle-blowing facility must be in place that allows employees to report concerns confidentially. In the absence of a whistle-blowing facility Tesco Protector Line must be used. Where Protector Line is used, the posters must be displayed in employee areas and the site must comply with Tesco Requirements for Suppliers *60418 - Protector Line*. *NB. Posters are available in several languages so the site can select as required*

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4 Environment, water and waste management

Consideration of the environment ensures that the site is compliant with the law, and not having an undue impact on the environment, which is positive for the planet, the reputation of the supplier and Tesco. It can also drive efficiency by reducing wasteful activities. Water is an essential part of any operation. Assessment of the water used in the manufacturing/packing process helps to ensure that safe, legal products are produced.

Applicable to maintenance audits for sites that do not hold valid ISO 14001:2015 certification

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	4.1	Environmental management system	The site must have an effective system for managing its environmental impact. This must include a policy that details responsibility for meeting local legislative requirements, minimising environmental impact and how this is measured. The system must ensure that: - environmental risks are identified and managed - control measures are regularly reviewed for effectiveness - site activities do not adversely impact the local environment.
P	R		4.2	Water treatment	The site must identify water treatment requirements based on risk. Where treatments are in place the site must ensure they are effective at all times through monitoring of critical parameters, as defined by local regulations.
		O	4.3	Waste segregation	Where recyclable materials are collected the site must have a system in place to ensure effective segregation.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	4.4	Water storage	Where water is stored, facilities must be of a suitable size, constructed from suitable materials, and designed to exclude light and pest entry. Controls must be in place to prevent Legionella within any storage facility or equipment where water may be stored for periods of time.
		O	4.5	Waste water and sewerage	Management of waste water and effluent must not cause a risk to the product or the health of employees and visitors. Sewer drains must not be vented or accessible within product areas.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		4.6	**Plants & Bulbs Only** - Peat usage, reduction and removal	The site must have a documented policy for their commitment to Peat removal. The documented policy should reflect the UK Government legislation at the time, applicable to all sites supplying the UK business, regardless of location, and should be reviewed 6-monthly as a minimum. The site should have a nominated person who is responsible for ensuring updates to UK Government Peat Removal legislation are tracked and communicated within their business and across their grower base. The site must have an active Peat removal plan and risk assessment for all products supplied to Tesco. Demonstrating by grower and product the progress of Peat reduction and removal for these products. The risk assessment should detail a list of products or lines most affected by peat removal, with contingency plans for supply continuity and quality maintenance (e.g., for crops where peat-free alternatives are not yet fully viable). The site must be able to validate grower Peat reduction and removal by conducting in-house shelf-life testing to ensure quality and performance of products with reduced Peat and removed Peat. The results must be presented back to the growers of the products and to the Tesco Technical Team. The site must be able to demonstrate evidence of regular communication and engagement with all growers regarding peat reduction targets, progress, and challenges. This could include forums, workshops, or documented updates. The site should obtain documentation from the grower base of trials with alternative substrates, including environmental impact assessments (e.g., carbon footprint, biodiversity, water use). Encourage sharing of best practices and learnings across the grower base.

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Supplier Assurance Clauses

5 External areas and site security

Maintenance of the site boundary and external areas, combined with good site security, minimises the risk of accidental or unauthorised access. It reduces the potential for contamination, adulteration or damage to facilities, equipment and the product as well as reducing the risk of pest activity.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	5.1	External areas	External areas immediately surrounding buildings must be maintained to prevent potential for pest harbourage, pooling of water and allow for effective cleaning.
		O	5.2	External units and equipment	External units (including storage containers and tanks) must be secure.
		O	5.2.2	Field packing/mobile units	Unauthorised access to field packing/mobile units must be prevented when not in use. Mobile units must not be stored next to spraying equipment. Product and packaging must not remain within the unit if left unattended overnight.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		5.3	Photographic recording equipment	Use of photographic/recording equipment on site must be controlled (including site issued and personal devices). The site must ensure that visitors are asked to declare any such equipment on arrival, and the site must authorise the use of any recording equipment before each time it is used.
P	R		5.4	Product defence	The site must assess the potential risks to raw materials, products, packaging and equipment from intentional contamination and tampering, and appropriate controls must be in place based on the risk assessment.
		O	5.5	Control of employees	Access to production/packing and storage areas, including external units, must be restricted to authorised personnel only.
P	R		5.6	Control of visitors and contractors	All visitors and contractors must be controlled while on site. They must also abide by the site's safety and hygiene rules at all times.
	R		5.7	Visitors to living accommodation /dormitories	A procedure must be in place to ensure that visitors to living accommodation located on site and provided by the company, must be signed in whilst on the site and sign out when leaving. This must also apply to any family members not employed by the site.

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6 Design and construction of premises

Good facility design and construction minimises the risk to the product of physical, chemical or microbiological contamination, while providing the correct conditions for production/packing and storage in a safe and efficient working environment

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	6.1	External structure and fabrication	The physical structure, fabrication, location and layout of buildings must not pose a risk to the product and must be suitable for the environment required. Boundaries must be clearly defined and where appropriate have adequate perimeter fencing. The site must comply with local regulations regarding approval or registration of premises and site usage. For sites outside of the European Union a valid building approval certificate covering all floors/buildings that has been issued by the relevant government body must be available on request.
		O	6.2	Internal structure	Walls, floors, ceilings, drains and doors must be designed, constructed and maintained so they do not pose a risk to product.
	R	O	6.3	Drains	A drain plan must be available for the site Drains must be accessible for cleaning. Drains must be proofed to prevent pest entry.
		O	6.4	Walkways	Walkways and steps over packing lines must be designed to prevent product contamination.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	6.5	Lighting	Lighting in all areas must enable safe working and good visibility. Adequate lighting must be in place above product inspection areas.
		O	6.6	Offices	Offices (including product testing and first aid rooms) with direct access to production/packing and storage areas must be managed so that they do not pose a risk to product.
		O	6.7	Services	All services must be designed from material suitable for the purpose and appropriate to the area where used, intact and allow easy and effective cleaning. This must include (where relevant), as a minimum: • pipework for water/gas/compressed air • electrical cabling/conduit/sockets • ventilation ducting, compressors/pumps, fire sprinkler systems
	R	O	6.7.1	Water systems	The site must have a plan of all water circuits within the site, which is reviewed at least annually. All water lines must be identified as potable or non-potable. There must be no 'dead ends' on potable water lines.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	6.8	Product and raw material storage areas	Storage areas must be fit for purpose and maintained in an appropriate condition. Materials must not be stored directly against the walls to allow inspection, prevent contamination, and prevent pest harbourage. If off-site storage facilities are used, including third parties, then controls must be in place to ensure the facilities meet the requirements of this Standard.
		O	6.9	External waste storage	Where used, external product waste containers must be covered. They must be managed to ensure a pest free environment.

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	R	O	6.10	Chemical management	All chemicals used on site must have a Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS). All chemicals must be used according to the manufacturer's instructions and legislative guidelines, including temperature, dilution and storage. They must be stored securely and in a way that does not present a risk to the product. Any chemicals transferred from their original containers must be correctly labelled with the contents, appropriate hazard warning labels. All post-harvest chemicals must be approved for the intended purpose. This must be supported by the relevant technical documents. When storing or handling post-harvest chemicals all local legislative requirements and site health and safety procedures must be followed. All plant protection products (PPPs) used on horticulture products must be legal and approved for use on the crops in question in the country of application. For all products supplied to Tesco, primary suppliers must provide a list of the PPPs their growers intend to use on their crop during the coming growing season. They must do this by submitting a PPP List, called a PPPL, on the Food Experts web-based platform (www.food-experts.com). A separate PPPL should be submitted for each of the following crops that are supplied, for each country they are grown in. • Daffodils (Ornamental) • Rose (Ornamental) • Chrysanthemums (Ornamental) • Carnations (Ornamental) • Generic (Ornamentals) – for all other crop types

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
					A PPPL does not need to be submitted for flowers or foliage harvested from the wild. Proposed Pesticide Usage (PPU) and spray records for contingency and spot purchase growers must be cross-referenced with the equivalent approved Tesco Plant Protection Product List (PPPL) for each crop registered with the Tesco-approved PPPL contractor.

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7 Design and construction of equipment

Good design and construction of equipment minimises the risk of contamination or damage to the product and ensures products are produced safely, to a consistent quality.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	7.1	Design, construction and location of equipment	All equipment must be properly specified, commissioned, checked against local legislation for suitability and risk assessed for product safety prior to use. Equipment must be designed, constructed and located to enable effective cleaning, maintenance, and servicing. Equipment must be maintained in a good condition to prevent foreign object risks.
		O	7.2	Equipment in storage	Equipment which is not being used must be stored so as not to pose a risk to the product.
		O	7.3	Mobile equipment	Mobile equipment (for example, forklift trucks, pallet trucks, gas heaters, fans, scissor lifts and ladders) must be clean, maintained and stored in a suitable area when not in use. Battery charging points must not be in open product areas unless the batteries are fully sealed/maintenance free.
	R	O	7.4	Environmental control equipment	Equipment used to control the environment (for example, temperature, humidity, controlled atmosphere) must be suitable to ensure the correct conditions are maintained at all times. Equipment must not pose a risk to the product.

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8 Operational hygiene and cleaning programme

Control of site hygiene and cleaning reduces the risk of product contamination and helps prevent the accidental use of defective materials.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	8.1	Cleanliness	Equipment and facilities must be maintained in a clean condition appropriate to product risk. Employees must be responsible for maintaining a clean and tidy working area.
P	R	O	8.1.1	Cleaning Risk Assessment	Machinery and equipment must be subjected to a full and thorough inspection as part of the risk assessment. This must take into account parts of machinery that are hard to reach and clean as worst-case scenarios, for example, dead ends of pipes, complex moving parts of machinery etc. Once controls have been validated, ongoing verification (for example, visual inspection after every clean etc.) must be in place to monitor their continued effectiveness. Whenever the process or product changes, the validation must be reviewed. Validation of controls must be reviewed at a frequency based on a risk assessment but at a minimum annually to make sure the controls in place remain effective and appropriate to control the hazards and risks identified

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		8.2	Cleaning accountability and resource	There must be a suitably competent person accountable for overseeing all cleaning functions and the standards achieved. Adequate supervision and verification checks must be in place to ensure cleaning is always carried out at times specified in the documented procedure and consistently completed to the standard required, which has been validated as effective. The frequency of these checks must be determined by risk assessment. Cleaning personnel must be trained and competent in the use and handling of chemicals and against cleaning procedures. The necessary resources and time must be set aside to ensure the cleaning schedule can be completed in full. Resources include personnel, cleaning equipment, chemicals and protective clothing. A review of cleaning resource must be regularly conducted to ensure there is enough time to clean to the required standard between production runs.
P	R		8.3	Cleaning schedules	Cleaning schedules must be determined by risk assessment and be in place across all areas. The risk assessment must be used to determine the level and frequency of cleaning required and the equipment that must be used. Cleaning schedules must be fully integrated into the production scheduling and planning process.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	8.4	Cleaning procedures	The site must have documented, validated cleaning procedures. These must include both equipment cleaned in situ and those cleaned in washrooms/manually. Cleaning in situ must not pose the risk of spreading contamination from one line/piece of equipment/area to another. Cleaning procedures must include, as a minimum, cleaning of: • equipment • production/packing, storage and maintenance areas • employee facilities • drains • external areas The procedures must contain: • cleaning methods • how often/when cleaning is needed • cleaning equipment and chemicals (including dilution and temperature) • details on how to disassemble and re-assemble equipment • to what level cleaning is required, for example visually clean, or chemical disinfection • cleaning verification Methods of cleaning must not pose a risk of contamination to nearby product. Automated cleaning equipment, for example tray washes, must operate at the correct temperature with correct chemical type and dilution at all times. Equipment must be monitored and verified. The frequency and type of checks must be determined by risk assessment.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		8.5	Cleaning records	Checklists including key equipment critical to product safety, legality and quality must be completed to demonstrate what cleaning has been completed and by whom. It must be the responsibility of a competent person to ensure cleaning is completed to the specified schedules and standards. Hygiene standards must be visually checked. Issues, re-cleaning and corrective actions relating to cleaning standards must be documented and reported to site management and the person responsible for cleaning activities.
		O	8.6	Cleaning equipment	Cleaning equipment must be fit for purpose, in good condition, easily cleanable and not pose a risk of foreign object contamination. All cleaning equipment must be stored in a manner which does not pose a risk of cross contamination.
	R	O	8.7	Cleaning chemicals	Cleaning chemicals must be suitable for the production/packing environment, equipment and their intended use. Phenolic or scented cleaning products must not be used.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	8.8	Accidental contamination	Immediately after an incident where there is a risk of product contamination (e.g. spillage) the site must ensure the following, as a minimum: • stop production/packing (when relevant) • control the contaminant and restrict personnel movement in and out of the area to limit access to those required and authorised personnel (for example, supervisor, staff responsible for clean-up) • Identify all potentially affected raw material, work in progress, finished product, equipment, and store them in way that prevents contamination of other products • use dedicated cleaning equipment and personal protective equipment to clear the spillage and any affected equipment, etc. • the cleaning and removal of the contaminant must be inspected and signed off by an authorised person • carry out risk assessment of the incident to determine actions needed and whether the potentially affected materials are safe and fit for use, whether they need to be further processed or whether they should not be used records of the above must be kept

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9 Maintenance

Maintenance of the structure and fabric of the buildings and equipment reduces the risk of contamination or damage to the product. Effective equipment maintenance supports the manufacture of products to a consistent quality.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	9.1	Equipment and facilities	Any maintenance or repairs to the structure and fabric of the building or equipment must be completed to a standard that does not pose a risk to the product.
P	R	O	9.2	Preventative maintenance programme	There must be a fully implemented planned preventative maintenance (PPM) programme that covers all equipment with the potential to affect safety, legality and quality.
P	R		9.3	Maintenance and engineering records	A system must be in place to record all maintenance and engineering work requested and planned preventative maintenance (PPM) work completed. Work must be prioritised and completed in the agreed timescales based on risk. Procedures must be in place to manage work not completed within agreed timescales.
	R	O	9.4	Engineers and mechanics	Repairs to or servicing of equipment must be completed by site engineers/mechanics, approved contractors or the equipment manufacturer.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	9.5	Temporary repairs	Temporary repairs must be controlled to ensure product is not put at risk. The material used to make the temporary repair must be appropriate and not pose a risk. A timescale for a permanent repair must be established and checks performed to ensure this is achieved.
		O	9.6	Engineering and maintenance workshops and tools	Engineering/Maintenance workshops and associated areas must have good standards of fabrication, hygiene and housekeeping. Measures must be taken to ensure that engineering areas do not pose a contamination risk to the rest of the site. Tools must be kept clean, well maintained and replaced when necessary. Tools and parts must be controlled. A system must highlight and initiate an investigation if a tool or part is missing. Product containers and Tesco trays must not be used as general storage containers in these areas.
P	R		9.7	Contamination control	Risk assessments must be completed prior to work commencing to ensure product and packaging is not put at risk. Engineering activities must be controlled and must not take place on equipment while it is being used for production/packing or on any equipment immediately adjacent, unless suitable hygienic screening is in place
		O	9.8	Parts	Whilst engineers work on production/packing equipment, small parts must be stored in sealed marked containers, magnetic mats or trays

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10 Pest management

Effective pest management programmes reduces the risk of infestation at the site and contamination of the product. Correctly skilled resources are essential to achieve this, to monitor the site routinely and respond rapidly to any issues which do occur.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		10.1	Management accountability	A trained and competent company employee must be accountable for the pest management programme and ensure that the specification is complied with and remains effective throughout the year, for example, frequency of inspections are consistent with activity. They must have access to all details of the pest management programme, including records.
P	R		10.2	Pest management programme	An effective pest management programme must be in place, based on a documented risk assessment that takes into account the following, as a minimum: • site location and surrounding environment • building design • raw materials and products on site • history of pest issues • different site areas • seasonal variations • operational periods The pest control provider may be a specialist or a trained employee. The programme must be reviewed annually as a minimum, or when a major issue occurs.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		10.3	Pest management programme specification	The pest management programme must be documented, agreed by the site and/or pest contractor and must include, as a minimum: • details of the pest control provider and evidence of their competence • frequency and type of inspections, based on risk • a site plan identifying the area covered by the programme and pest monitoring and control points • the pests covered • the pest management methods and procedures in use, including follow up inspections. follow up frequency following infestation is agreed and documented on a case by case basis ensuring it is appropriate to the infestation • Electric Fly Killer (EFK) tube change frequency (where used) • material safety data sheets (MSDS) for all chemicals used • emergency call out details • details of how the programme complies with all local legislation (for example, bird control, traps etc.)
	R		10.4	Pest management records	During each visit or inspection, activity/action reports must be completed and include the following, as a minimum: • all observations of pests or evidence of pest activity • updated pest activity trend analysis • review of actions since last visit • recommendations for action by the site • details of any chemicals used • pest proofing requirements • poor hygiene/housekeeping conditions • difficulties accessing or lost/missing pest monitoring and/or control points • review by the site employee accountable for the pest management programme

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	10.5	Pest monitoring and control	Pest monitoring and control points must be appropriately positioned for the intended pests. They must be robust, tamper-proof, and secured/fixed to walls or floors to prevent removal. They must not present a risk to the product. Spray or fumigation treatments must be controlled, not carried out during production/packing and not over uncovered product.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R	O	10.6	Live catch and break back traps	Where used, live catch systems must be inspected daily* or more frequently where required by in country legislation. This can be done by the pest control provider or a trained on site person. Where used, break back traps must be enclosed, tamper proof and have an indicator to show if the trap has been activated. The design must be such that it gives an immediate kill. Break back traps must only be used in production and packing areas with permission of the Tesco Technical contact. Break back traps used internally must be checked at least weekly where they are being used for monitoring activity. Daily checks* are required where they are being used to manage an infestation, to observe if they have been activated, until no evidence of activity for 7 consecutive days. Where break back traps are used externally these should be inspected at a frequency defined by risk assessment. *Remotely connected systems/traps, which are constantly monitored by the pest management company are deemed to meet this requirement This can be done by the pest management provider or a trained on site person.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R	O	10.7	Toxic bait	Toxic baits must not be used in open product areas unless treating an active infestation. Toxic baits must not be used routinely in production/packing and storage areas, unless in enclosed access panels. Loose/granular toxic baits must not be used in open product areas, production/packing and storage areas (for example, poison grain). Gels or blocks must be used.

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11 Training

Effective and relevant training and regular skills assessment ensures that all employees are able to carry out their activities safely and competently, resulting in safe, legal and consistent quality.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		11.1	Training	The site must ensure that all personnel performing activities related to product safety, legality and quality are competent to carry out their activity, through training, work experience or qualification, and have been trained against the latest version of all relevant procedures. The site must document what is required to ensure the personnel performing activities relating to product safety, legality and quality are competent to carry it out. There must be a system for verifying competence (for example, through evaluation, examination or testing).
	R		11.2	Induction	All relevant personnel, including agency, temporary staff and contractors must undergo appropriate initial training prior to commencing work and be adequately supervised. Product handlers must have an understanding of product safety, legality and quality appropriate to their role before they start work. In the event that the initial training content is updated or changed, all relevant personnel must be made aware of the changes.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	11.2.1	Contamination Risk Training	Appropriate training must be provided to all relevant staff and visitors. Sites must provide training that is effective in ensuring that all employees and visitors including agency staff and contractors are aware of and understand the risks and consequences associated with all potential contaminants on site. Employees must receive sufficiently detailed training on any specific controls and procedures for maintaining segregation which directly form part of their job role. This includes non-production personnel such as those involved in new product development, engineers, cleaning staff, laboratory staff and production planners.
	R		11.3	Trainers	Training must be delivered by competent personnel.
	R	O	11.4	Language	The level of language understanding must be known for all personnel (including agency or temporary personnel). The site must provide information, instruction, training and supervision in an understandable format for all workers, irrespective of their national origins, first language or literacy. The level of language understanding must be appropriate to the role in relation to product safety, legality and quality.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	11.5	Training records	Records of all training must be available. Where training is undertaken by agencies on behalf of the site, records of the training must be available. This must include, as a minimum: • the name of the trainee • the date of the training • the title or course contents, procedures covered • the training provider • evidence of successful training • copies of certificates may form part of these records for example, Safe use of chemicals • signature of trainer • signature of trainee indicating that they have understood the training • when refresher training is required The competency of employees must be reviewed at defined intervals and re-training undertaken where necessary. Where competency tests are used, wrong answers are reviewed with, and corrected by the trainee to demonstrate full understanding.
	R		11.6	Job descriptions	All personnel must have a clear understanding of what is expected of them in their job roles. Documented and agreed job descriptions (or working instructions) must be available for personnel responsible for activities related to product safety, legality and quality.

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12 Employee facilities and workwear

Provision of suitably controlled employee facilities ensures that the risk of contamination to the product is reduced. Appropriate workwear ensures the protection of the product from contamination and protects the wearer when carrying out potentially hazardous tasks.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	12.1	Employee facilities	Employee facilities (including rest areas, toilets, locker areas and changing areas) must be provided, where appropriate, and maintained in a clean and hygienic condition.
		O	12.2	Toilets	Toilets must be 'fit for purpose' for the nationality and gender of staff, whilst being maintained in a clean and hygienic condition. Hand wash sinks and drying facilities must be present. Hand washing signs must be displayed in toilet areas.
		O	12.3	Smoking	Smoking (including electronic cigarettes) must not take place in production/packing or storage areas, or offices and workshops with direct access to production/packing or storage areas when it poses a risk to the product. Where provided, smoking areas must comply with local legislation, must be maintained in a clean condition and have appropriate fire-safe bins. Smoking debris must not be disposed of on the floor. Where activities are field based, smoking requirements must apply around field operations.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	12.4	Employee changing rooms and lockers	All sites must have a dedicated space to allow employees to leave their own belongings and to change into and out of workwear, where required. Where provided, lockers must be kept clean, in good condition and not used to store food.
P	R	O	12.5	Workwear risk assessment	The type of workwear, including Personal Protective Equipment (PPE), worn by employees must be determined by risk assessment.
P	R	O	12.6	Workwear	Workwear (including personal clothing, where worn) must not pose a risk to the product, must be in good condition, clean, and appropriate to the activities being carried out. Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) must be worn for any hazardous activities (for example, chemical handling).
		O	12.7	Canteen and staff rest areas	Where a site provides canteen facilities, staff rest areas or a food service the area must be clean and fit for purpose. These areas must not be used for production or storage.
	R		12.8	Consumption and storage of personal food	Consumption and storage of personal food must only take place in designated areas that ensure there is no risk to the product. The drinking of water must not pose a risk to the product. Where activities are field based, personal food must be stored away from the harvest area (for example, remain in the worker's or company vehicle).

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	12.9	Hand washing facilities	Sufficient numbers of hand washing and sanitising (where required) facilities must be available and located to allow employees to clean their hands when required. Water temperature must not discourage people from washing their hands i.e. too hot or too cold.

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13 Personal health and hygiene

Effective personal health and hygiene management on site minimises the risk of contamination of the site, equipment and product.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P		O	13.1	Personal hygiene	Personal health and hygiene standards that prevent product contamination or taint must be in place at the site. Site or operational personal hygiene requirements must be documented. All personnel, visitors and contractors must be required to read, understand and accept health, hygiene and safety rules prior to entering production/packing and storage areas.
		O	13.2	Hand washing	Hand washing and/or sanitising must take place whenever required, to minimise direct or indirect contamination of product, and immediately prior to handling products or product contact equipment.
P		O	13.3	Jewellery	Personal jewellery must not pose a physical or microbiological risk to the product. Site jewellery policy must be based on risk assessment for the products being produced. Jewellery may be permitted for medical or religious reasons included in site risk assessment.
		O	13.4	Plasters	All cuts and grazes on exposed skin must be covered. The plaster/wound dressing must be of a contrasting colour to the product. Procedures must be in place to identify if a plaster is lost and ensure there is no risk to the product.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P		O	13.5	Personal items	Personal items (for example, keys (except locker keys), watches, personal mobile phones, coins and medicines) must not be taken into packing or storage areas. Where personal medicines must be kept on the person at all times, these must be suitably controlled to ensure they cannot contaminate the product.
P	R		13.6	Loss of lenses	Procedures must be in place for the breakage/loss of glasses and contact lenses.
P	R		13.7	Pre-employment Health Assessment	All employees must be assessed for health risks that could affect products before entering packing or storage areas for the first time. The type of assessment may vary dependent upon local legislation, for example, doctor's assessment. The assessment must be reviewed by a suitably competent person.
P	R		13.8	Visitors and contractors	Where local legislation allows, before being allowed into production/packing and storage areas, visitors and contractors must confirm in writing they do not present any health risks that may compromise product safety. Individual declarations must be completed then checked, assessed and signed by a suitably competent site representative. The type of assessment may vary dependent upon local legislation.
P	R		13.9	Reporting illness	Employees must report any illness to their line manager as soon as it occurs. A decision must be made as to whether the employee can continue to work, and whether they are restricted areas where there is no risk to product until medical fitness has been confirmed.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		13.10	Return to work	A risk assessment must be completed prior to employees returning to work after illness. This must be overseen by a suitably competent person. A procedure for returning to work after illness must be in place. People who have suffered from vomiting or diarrhoea must not enter packing or storage areas until they have been symptom free for a minimum of 48 hours. Certain infections may require a longer period of exclusion from packing or storage areas (for example, enteric fever, norovirus and Hepatitis A).
P	R		13.11	Procedures for clearing illness in the workplace	Procedures must be in place for managing any bodily fluid spillages for example, vomiting, and bleeding within the production/packing and storage areas.
P	R		13.12	Emergency services entry	Procedures must be in place following emergency personnel entry into packing areas in emergency situations (for example, medical or fire personnel). They must include any cleaning requirements prior to re-starting packing and requirements for potentially contaminated product.

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Product Assurance Clauses

14 Supplier management

An effective supplier management process ensures that sites receive safe, legal material, of the desired quality, from reputable suppliers. This in turn reduces the risks to the consumer relating to safety, legality and quality. It is essential that the site takes the responsibility to manage the risk within their raw materials and supplier base with respect to quality, provenance and responsible sourcing, to enable consumer trust in the supply chain.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P			14.1	Supplier selection and risk assessment	An effective supplier selection system must be in place for all suppliers of raw materials, product components. *('Suppliers' include non-manufacturing suppliers and contingency suppliers. Sites do not need to approve suppliers of Tesco dedicated branded trays and crates, where used. 'Raw materials' include packaging, plant food, and accessories).* Suppliers must be risk assessed and approved prior to supply and on an ongoing basis. This must include assessment of the ability to deliver to the required specification and capacity to deliver to the required volume. Where the supplier risk assessment identifies first party audits are required: • the audit must be against an appropriate standard, by a competent auditor • the audit must have a satisfactory result and no unresolved critical or major non-conformances prior to supply. Full reports and corrective action plans must be available to view on site Where the supplier risk assessment identifies third party audits are required: • valid certification of the Tesco product and processes, to an appropriate standard must be available The Tesco Technical contact must be informed and provide documented authorisation prior to using materials from a contingency supplier or producer. Documented records must be maintained to demonstrate the risk assessment decisions, approval and monitoring methods for all approved suppliers.

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	R		14.2	Raw material risk assessment and approval	Sites manufacturing Tesco products must ensure that sites supplying raw materials undertake a risk assessment and establish the appropriate validated controls, to prevent contamination or unintended presence of substances in raw materials before they arrive on site. Tesco suppliers' risk assessment of their suppliers and raw materials must take into account: • Products handled at the supplier and the controls in place to manage segregation where needed. • Audit history, including third-party audits if appropriate. • The potential for cross contamination or unintentional substitution of raw materials at any point when handled by previous suppliers in the supply chain including during transportation. • Any known issues or problems at the supplier such as foreign objects, microbiological or chemical risks, product recalls and Emergency Product Withdrawals (EPWs), packaging errors etc Tesco suppliers must specify to their suppliers that they must be provided with details of all of the raw materials handled on the raw material supplier site, the potential for contamination and how that is controlled. Tesco suppliers must make sure that they make it a requirement for their raw materials supplier to notify them where there are any changes to their site that could affect the risk of cross contamination and review whether this affects the risk rating and therefore the controls and monitoring in place. Tesco suppliers must make sure that their suppliers have controls that mitigate the risks identified in place and these have been appropriately validated as effective. *Where Tesco suppliers' risk assessments identify high-risk raw material suppliers, it is recommended not to rely only on Questionnaires as evidence that risks are well controlled; Tesco suppliers must consider other means of verification that controls are implemented effectively including, but not limited to those above.* Any raw material must be risk assessed, approved, and receive ongoing assessment. *(Continued on next page)*

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
					Risk assessments must take into account the supplier, producers, off-site production and outsourced processes. Risk assessments must be reviewed following any changes at raw material sites that could affect the risk assessment. Approval, monitoring and raw material testing processes must be based on the outcome of the risk assessment carried out on each raw material and/or supplier, and take into account any specific raw material supplier policies for the Tesco Business Unit being supplied. Documented records must be maintained to demonstrate the risk assessment decisions, approval and monitoring methods for all approved materials.
	R		14.3	Offsite production and outsourced processes	All off site production and outsourced processing must be visible on the process flow diagram, declared to Tesco and agreed with the Tesco Technical contact. It must be risk assessed and approved prior to use and undergo ongoing assessment. If the Tesco brand can be identified during offsite production or outsourced processing, the outsourced site must be approved by Tesco. Ongoing approval and monitoring must be based on risk. Offsite production and outsourced process providers must be approved in the same way that raw material suppliers are approved. They must receive ongoing assessment, annually as a minimum. They must comply with all relevant requirements of this Standard, any relevant Modules and Tesco Requirements for Suppliers.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		14.4	Outsourced processes – mid process	For outsourced processes where the material or product returns to the site, full specifications must be in place which describe the product, packaging and processing detail accurately. Raw material, products and packaging from outsourced processes must be subject to intake checks.
P	R		14.5	Outsourced processes – at end of process	For outsourced processes where the material or product does not return to the primary site for further processing, the outsourced site must be approved by Tesco, unless agreed by the Tesco Technical contact.
	R		14.6	Approved suppliers	Sites must ensure that all raw materials are only purchased from suppliers which have been subjected to the site's approval process. As part of that approval, raw materials suppliers must demonstrate that they meet the standards required by Tesco. If a potential contaminant within the raw materials is identified the effect and impact it will have on the final product and consumer must be assessed. If full removal or replacement is not an option, the potential contaminants must be documented and made available to all relevant employees to ensure awareness and understanding of the risks associated with the materials they handle within their job role, for themselves and the end consumer, and area of the site they work in. If the removal of the risk(s) is not possible, controls must be in place to effectively manage the risk. Details of all approved suppliers and manufacturers/producers, and the materials they supply, must be held by the site.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		14.7	Raw material specifications	The site must have a specification that includes Tesco requirements (where relevant), for all raw materials that is agreed by both the Tesco supplier and the raw material supplier.

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15 Product safety and risk assessment

Hazard analysis and risk assessment ensure that safe products are consistently produced, and HACCP systems are fundamental in supporting the required due diligence of all processes.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		15.1	Pre-requisite programmes	All environmental and operational controls (including segregation management) that are necessary to produce safe and legal products must be in place. The control measures and monitoring procedures for the pre-requisite programme must be clearly identified and documented.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		15.2	The use of HACCP	All sites must have a product safety system which is maintained, implemented and documented. This risk assessment must include an assessment of all raw materials, components, finished products and their derivatives on site. This must incorporate and consider their storage, transport and processing. New product development, and sub-contracted processes in third-party sites must also be risk assessed. The outcome of the risk assessment must provide a clear understanding of what products and raw materials are at risk from what contaminants and where in the process this could occur This must include detailed procedures clearly recording the process and those responsible whilst considering the following as a minimum: • intended product use • potential product misuse • legal requirements *(Continued on next page)*

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		15.2 (continued)	The use of HACCP (continued)	HACCP systems must be based on Codex Alimentarius principles which include a minimum of: assessment of the hazards, taking into account: • likelihood of occurrence and severity • contamination of raw materials (internal or external), work-in-progress (WIP) and finished product (chemical, physical, allergenic, fraud (for example intentional adulteration or substitution), and malicious contamination) • determining CCP's • establish validated critical limits • monitoring and control measures • corrective actions • documentation procedures (documents must be signed by the person completing the check, and then verified by an authorised person) • verification procedures (can include internal audits, review of complaints and testing results) All documents must be validated, signed and dated by the HACCP team.
P		O	15.2.1	Mitigating Risk	On completion of a risk assessment the action needed to manage the risk identified must be established. In order to ensure effective action is taken the following hierarchy of controls must be reviewed. These are given in the order of most effective first: • remove the risk from the product or process • minimise the risk to the lowest acceptable level • manage the remaining or residual risk through procedures If the risk cannot be removed completely, the importance of why processes and controls that manage the risk need to be in place must be communicated to all relevant personnel and followed.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P		O	15.2.2	Control mechanisms	Once all potential contaminants and the potential locations for cross-contamination have been identified through the risk assessment control mechanisms must be put in place. Where the risk cannot be prevented or eliminated, it must be minimised and managed through controls and procedures that have been validated as effective.
P	R		15.2.3	Validation and verification of controls	Sites must carry out validation to demonstrate that the controls are effective in preventing contamination of the final product. Ongoing monitoring must be in place to verify that the controls are implemented consistently and that they continue to be effective. The type of risk and form of the risk must always be taken into consideration to ensure the control is suitable. Evidence of the validation process and results from ongoing verification of the controls put in place must be documented.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		15.3	HACCP team	The HACCP plan must be developed by a multi-disciplinary team which has the correct product knowledge and expertise. The team leader must have appropriate knowledge of HACCP/risk management and be able to demonstrate competence and experience. This can be demonstrated by: • the quality of the plan and its adherence to the Codex Alimentarius principles • successfully completed, formal and up to date HACCP/risk management training • demonstrable, extensive experience in implementing and/or training HACCP/risk management • no site history of HACCP/risk management related major non-conformances arising from third party audits Other team members must also have knowledge of HACCP/risk management, product, process and the associated hazards. In the event that the site (or wider company) does not have the appropriate in-house knowledge (either product expertise and/or HACCP/risk management), external expertise may be used. However, the day-to-day management of the product safety systems must remain the responsibility of the site. The site must be able to demonstrate that a full handover was given and that the site and relevant employees have full understanding of the output.
P	R		15.4	Product and its intended use	A full description of the product must be documented including relevant safety information. The intended use of the product by the customer, must be described, defining the target consumer groups, including the suitability of the product for vulnerable groups of the population (for example, infants, elderly, pregnant women, and people with allergies / sensitivities).

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		15.5	Process flow	A product and process flow diagram must be prepared to set out all aspects of the operation, from raw material receipt through processing, storage and distribution. The diagram must cover all products, product categories and/or processes as appropriate.
	R		15.6	Site plan	A site plan must be available. The site plan must include, as a minimum (where relevant): • site boundaries and access points • plan of premises and equipment layout • product and process flow including raw material flows, introduction of utilities and other materials, for example, water, packaging • people flows • sequence and interaction of all process steps • critical control points • process delay (for example, conditioning) • outsourced processes and subcontracted work • rework, recycling and waste • key segregation points in the process or site

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		15.7	Risk Assessment Review	The risk assessment must be reviewed annually as a minimum, and updated if there are any changes to the following, as a minimum: • manufacturing process or equipment used • packing schedules, in particular where one product might contain components that have potential to contaminate products packed using the same equipment later • production volumes, for example introduction of new product lines or increased demand • formulation of the product • any other products being produced on site (either for Tesco or another customer) • raw materials • raw materials handled at your suppliers' sites • new products to be produced on site • site design and layout • cleaning procedures • following any incident where the segregation system has failed.

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16 Product development and specifications

Product design and development procedures, including risk assessment, ensure that new products or processes, or changes to product, packaging or processes, results in the consistent production of safe and legal products to the agreed specification.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		16.1	Finished product and in-process specifications	Agreed specifications must be available on the relevant Tesco due diligence platform for all launched products. Where internal specifications are used, they must be controlled and accurately reflect the current Tesco specification. As a minimum, the relevant information from the specification must be available on site for all products. All specifications must be accurate, up to date and reviewed every two years as a minimum.
	R	O	16.2	Using the Tesco due diligence platform(s)	Users of the Tesco due diligence platform must be trained to operate the system to ensure the following information is up to date: • details of supplier, site and operating periods • specifications are associated to the correct site • all alerts have been acknowledged Relevant employees must be familiar with the Tesco due diligence platform and where to access the Tesco policies, requirements and guidance relevant for their products. Where a site does not have access to the Tesco due diligence platform the site must have copies of all relevant documentation for their Tesco products.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		16.3	Product development handover	The site must have a development handover process that ensures that approved product development and packaging materials are correctly transferred for the first production/packing run and that the specification is consistently achieved.
	R		16.4	Product development trials	The site must undertake and document production/packing trials and testing to ensure processes and equipment are capable of producing safe, legal products to the correct specification. New products, changes to existing products, processes and equipment must be adequately assessed for legal, safety and quality issues, discussed and agreed with the Tesco Technical contact. All product, packaging and process development must be assessed against the HACCP/risk management plan by the HACCP/risk management team to ensure the HACCP/risk management plan is still appropriate.
	R	O	16.5	Shelf/vase life	An appropriate finished product shelf/vase life must be established. The retention period and storage conditions for shelf/vase life samples must be agreed with the Tesco Technical contact and documented in the product specification.
	R		16.6	Product claims	Where certain product claims* are made, documentary evidence must be available on site to substantiate these. *Claims in scope: • product or component origin/provenance claims • claims about product properties, quality etc. • marketing claims • method of production/growing (for example, organic)

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		16.7	Packaging performance	Performance and durability of product and packaging must be conducted through testing (for example, transit trials, stack testing). Packaging design and testing must take into account how the product is sold (i.e. sale in store or supply direct to the consumer). Use of recycled materials must be controlled and any effects on product must be risk assessed and suitable controls put in place.

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17 Process control

Appropriate controls, monitoring and records covering receipt of raw materials, work-in-progress, production/packing, processing, finished product, processes and equipment, through to the despatch of finished product, and including the management of out of specification materials, prevents inadequate, faulty, unsafe or illegal products from reaching the consumer.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R	O	17.1	Process control	Relevant controls and records must be in place during the process to ensure all product conforms to the product specification.
P	R		17.2	Delivery vehicle security	Procedures must be in place to quarantine and risk assess any products/raw materials where the safety or quality has potentially been affected because of access by unauthorised people at any point in the journey. Any material deemed to be potentially affected after risk assessment must be suitably isolated and securely disposed of. The Tesco Technical contact must be informed and be involved in the final decision concerning the products/raw materials.
		O	17.2.1	Product identification	Once any raw material, work-in-progress or finished product has, through risk assessment, been identified as a potential risk for cross-contamination it must be clearly identifiable.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		17.3	Intake checks	The site must have documented procedures in place for the inspection and testing of all raw materials and product components against an approved specification. Controls must ensure that materials do not compromise the safety, legality, integrity or quality of products. All incoming raw materials, that require inspection and testing, must not be used until the inspection and testing processes have been completed. All raw materials including packaging must be checked by trained staff on receipt according to documented procedures and against agreed specifications. Raw material checks must include, as a minimum: • supplier is approved • condition of vehicle • raw material compliance to specification • records of plant protection product treatments, management of harvest intervals and residue testing • temperature (where required) • evidence of pest infestation (low level evidence of pest infestation may be acceptable for some materials) • packaging integrity • date/lot coding • pallet condition
	R	O	17.4	Non-conforming materials	Non-conforming materials, including finished product, must be controlled in a way that prevents them from being used or posing a risk to other raw materials or product.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		17.5	Hold and release	A documented procedure for risk assessment must be in place to manage the release of non-conforming raw materials and packaging. The risk assessment must include the following, as a minimum: • the issue that led to the non-conformance (including processing failure) • the intended use of the material • the significance of the issue Records must be kept of products on hold and released. They must include, as a minimum: • checks to ensure all affected product has been isolated • total quantities • identification codes • the time and date raw materials or packaging is put on hold and released • who released the raw materials or packaging, and under what conditions (for example, re-grading, packing as normal, rejecting to supplier, disposal etc.)

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	17.6	Segregation during storage and processing	Risk assessment must identify materials which need segregation during storage and processing. Where required, suitable segregation controls must be used to prevent cross contamination or taint, and to retain the identity of the product. If dedicated lines are not in place for materials requiring segregation, the scheduling of production and cleaning must ensure the risk of cross-contamination is minimised. All equipment (including production/packing lines) used for materials requiring segregation must be cleaned using a method which removes any risk of cross-contamination (for example, chemical cleaning, hot water cleaning, clearance of line (equipment dismantled where possible)), prior to use for products not requiring segregation. The type of cleaning must be selected based on site risk assessment and full validation and verification of the cleaning process.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P		O	17.7	Storage conditions	A risk assessment must be completed to make sure that the finished product storage conditions are appropriate to prevent cross-contamination from products that contain raw materials that could be a contaminant for other products, for example, allergens which are declared in one product but not intended to be in another and therefore not declared . Finished products that pose any risk of contamination to other products must be appropriately packaged and segregated in clearly identified separate areas where possible. Controls required for the storage of finished products shall be applied to any third-party storage facilities used by the site. Where raw materials, work-in-progress, rework and finished products need to be stored under controlled environmental conditions, conditions must remain within set ranges and a programme of environmental monitoring must be in place, including outside of normal site operating hours. Procedures must be in place to take appropriate corrective actions when the environment is found to be outside the specified tolerance. Where continuous monitoring is not in place, there must be a system that immediately identifies when conditions are outside the set ranges. A history of the storage conditions must be maintained. Where external storage of raw materials, work-in-progress, rework, finished product and equipment is unavoidable, items must be secure, protected from deterioration, contamination and pests, and must be inspected or decontaminated prior to use. This includes all Tesco reusable product containers.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		17.8	Stock rotation and material control	A system must be in place to ensure that raw materials and work-in-progress are used in the appropriate order. Where 'first expiry-first out' (FEFO) or 'first in-first out' (FIFO) is not used to determine the order in which raw materials and/or work-in-progress are used, this must be justified appropriately,
	R		17.9	Start up and change over controls	Prior to start up and changeovers, production/packing lines must be clear of all previous products, packaging and physical contamination hazards, and cleaned to a standard appropriate to the risk to the product.
P		O	17.10	Material and product transfer	Procedures must be in place to ensure the movement of either raw materials or finished product to and from different site areas does not pose a risk of cross-contamination.
	R	O	17.11	Work-in-progress	Work-in-progress (WIP) must be clearly labelled with internal use/process by dates, time, and product details and protected from contamination where necessary. WIP shelf life must be established with reference to the maximum total product shelf life.
		O	17.12	Part-used raw materials	Opened or part used raw material batches (including any used for product development work) must be controlled, where appropriate.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		17.13	Rework	Rework must be risk assessed in order to determine whether the rework itself could pose a contamination risk. Where rework is defined as permitted on the specification, it must all be traceable. The site must have a process in place for assessing the out of specification materials and either approving, rejecting or reworking the material. The use of rework must be detailed in the Tesco specification, including the percentage permitted. Where rework is permitted and used, this must be appropriately controlled, must not negatively affect product quality, safety or legality, and the final product must meet the Tesco specification. A rework shelf life must be established.
		O	17.14	Trays and containers	Trays/containers of work-in-progress, part-used raw materials, rework or finished product must be fit for purpose. Trays/containers used for waste material must be visibly different to those used for product. Tesco branded trays/containers must not be used for waste.
	R	O	17.15	Shelf/vase life and sample retention	Systems for managing minimum and maximum shelf/vase life when delivered to Tesco must be in place (for example, minimum number of days a product must have until the end of its shelf life, when received by Tesco). This must take into account any intermediate steps in the supply chain.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		17.16	Product release	The site must ensure that only product that meets the agreed specifications, and the correct quantity, is released for despatch. The site must ensure that product is not released for despatch unless all agreed procedures have been followed.
P	R		17.17	Product returns	A system must be in place to manage products which have been rejected and returned to the site. Product rejected by Tesco for quality reasons may only be reworked and/or re-delivered to Tesco following authorisation by the Tesco Technical contact. Re-labelling of returned/rejected product may only be carried out with written approval from the Tesco Technical contact. For returned products that are intended for re-delivery to Tesco, where environmental control is required, this control must have been maintained throughout the process of returning the product to the site.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R	O	17.18	Finished product disposal and surplus stock	All product disposal routes must be agreed with the Tesco Technical contact. Any rejected product must be securely disposed of through an authorised route. In countries where secure disposal is not possible the Tesco packaging must be removed or defaced. The site must have full control over surplus stock and know the quantities of product in the event this information is needed for mass balance exercises. Prior to any surplus stock being made available for purchase by site staff, Tesco branded packaging must be removed or defaced. Where it is not possible to remove the packaging, the barcode and all references to Tesco must be removed or permanently masked. This includes the Tesco name, address, trademarks and any other indications of the Tesco identity. Where surplus stock is donated to charitable organisations, the site must ensure the product is adequately controlled by the organisation.
		O	17.19	Controlled waste	Controlled waste must be suitably segregated and managed. It must be collected in identified containers. It must be removed in such a way that it does not present a risk to the product.
	R		17.20	Product deviation	If the finished product deviates from the agreed specification your Tesco Technical contact must be notified and the product must be quarantined pending risk assessment. Tesco must be notified immediately of any illegal and/or unsafe products which have been produced and despatched.

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18 Labelling and coding

Control of packaging, labelling and coding ensures that the correct product or components are packed into the correct outer packaging, along with the correct preparation instructions, where applicable. Accurate coding and labelling enables effective traceability, withdrawal and recall.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	18.1	Control of labelling and coding	Suppliers must have appropriate systems in place to verify that finished products are packed into the correct packaging. Checks must be in place before, during and after production runs to make sure that packaging used is correct throughout the production run, including where products are packed into multipacks. All coding information applied to a product must be correct, reflect the requirements detailed in the product specification and have recorded checks. Records with evidence of labels used must be authorised and retained.
P	R		18.2	Packaging supplied to the production/ packing line	Packaging supplied to the production/packing line must be controlled and checked to ensure it is correct and for the right product. Printed material and labels must be stored in a controlled area until issued. Records of packaging supplied must be maintained to support traceability and recall procedures.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R	O	18.3	Control of coded packaging	All unused coded packaging must be accounted for and disposed of.
	R		18.4	Managing code changes	The time of any code changes must be documented in the product specification (i.e. when the code moves to the next day, for example at midnight). Where the code change does not take place at midnight (for example, at the start of a shift), this must be agreed with the Tesco Technical contact.
	R		18.5	Label verification	Label and coding checks must be completed for all packing runs (including 'top up' runs) and include all packaging labels. Checks must be conducted at start up, end of production/packing run and after line disruption (for example, fire- alarm, breakdown, breaks).as a minimum. Checks during the production/packing run must be carried out at a frequency based on risk.
	R		18.6	Control of barcodes	Barcodes on all packaging must be checked against Tesco issued information before the packaging is used. Online printed bar codes must be checked and recorded at regular intervals.
	R		18.7	Re-labelling	Replacement of product labels due to printing faults or incorrect labelling must be completed in a controlled manner and records must be retained including the reasons for re-labelling. This must only be carried out following written approval from the Tesco Technical contact. Over-labelling of product labels must not be permitted.

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19 Traceability

Effective traceability systems enable all raw materials, components, work-in-progress, packaging and finished products to be identified and fully traced to their source.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		19.1	Traceability	The site must be able to trace all raw materials, including primary packaging, forwards from their suppliers through all stages of the operation and despatch of the finished product to Tesco. The site must be able to trace all finished product backwards, through all stages of the operation, to raw materials, including primary packaging, and to their suppliers. Records must include, as a minimum: • details for all materials from receipt of delivery • volumes of stock • the quantity that has been despatched • when despatched and to which location • all relevant records relating to product safety, quality and legality (including but limited to Plant Passports and Phytosanitary Certificates) Where the site is purchasing from agents or brokers then the site must ensure that the agent or broker is able to provide the same level of traceability. Materials from contingency suppliers must be fully traceable. Where a site is selling to Tesco through a service provider, non-manufacturing suppliers, then that organisation must be able to provide the same level of traceability.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
		O	19.2	Lot identification	Identification of raw materials, packaging, processing aids, work-in-progress, finished products and non-conforming materials must ensure traceability both forwards and backwards.
P	R		19.3	Traceability testing	The site must complete tests to ensure full traceability, volume reconciliation and document retrieval can be achieved from raw material intake via the process to finished product despatch (i.e. quantities produced/packed and where they have gone) and vice versa. This must occur at a scheduled frequency, at least twice per year. Where testing is done on non-Tesco products, it must be representative of the relevant Tesco product and all associated processes. All of the above must be achievable within 4 hours, for example, during an audit. Presentation of information within 24 hours is acceptable where it is held off-site in a country in a significantly different time zone. For example, where the audit site is in the UK, and the raw material site is in New Zealand.
	R		19.4	Traceability using bulk storage and topping up	Where the site has bulk storage and a system of topping up is used (for example, with each delivery) the site must maintain traceability.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		19.5	Mass balance system requirements and testing	The site must be able to account for raw material and packaging usage accurately through mass balance. The site must understand and be able to explain expected production/packing losses and tolerances associated with its process. Where mass balance exercises return results outside of the expected tolerances, corrective action must be taken. Mass balance of key raw materials and components must be tested at a predetermined frequency, once per year as a minimum.
	R		19.6	Reconciliation of volume or quantity of stock items related to a product claim	Where a finished product claim is made regarding components, mass balance/reconciliation of the quantity of the relevant materials must be tested once per year as a minimum.

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20 Quantity control

Control of product quantity ensures that the product is correct and legal when sold to the consumer.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		20.1	Procedures and personnel	Sites must have a documented procedure for the management of declared contents. This must cover all products to ensure conformance to the legal requirements in the intended country of sale. In the absence of country legislation, the procedure must ensure compliance to the Tesco specification for each product. Where statistical methods are used to manage quantity, appropriate procedures and equipment must be in place. Records must show the finished product results for each batch and show they comply with the product specification and any declared contents. For products produced/packed to average contents, records must show the average and upper/lower results for each batch. Procedures must detail the actions to be taken if the results fail to meet the specification including the segregation of non-conforming products. Results must be signed off by a competent person at the end of each batch. All personnel involved in the management of product quantity must be trained in the associated procedures and equipment use.
	R		20.2	Target quantity	Sites must document the target quantity and action limits for each product. Sites must be able to demonstrate that the finished product target quantities are routinely achievable during the process and keep records to demonstrate this

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		20.3	Frequency of product quantity checks	Where automated in-line product quantity checks are in place, checks must be for each Tesco batch. Where manual product checks are in place, a minimum routine sampling plan must be in operation to monitor and record final pack quantities, providing representative records for every Tesco batch. Sampling plans for manual product checks must be appropriate to the product in question. The plan must include: • checks at the start and end of a production/packing run (at least 5 products) • checks after disruptions in the production/packing run • the frequency of the checks must otherwise be appropriate to the product, but in all cases there must be at least 10 per hour
	R	O	20.4	Records	Records must be maintained showing the quantity results for each batch. Records for each batch must be checked to ensure they comply with the product specification and product labelling by a competent person.
P	R		20.5	Average quantity	Where product is packed to average count it must be done so in a manner which is compliant to the law in the countries where the product is being sold.
P	R		20.6	Minimum quantity	Where product is packed to meet a minimum declared quantity, all packs must contain at least the minimum declared quantity.
P	R	O	20.7	Count control	Where the number of items is declared on packaging and the count is verified with a weight check the site must adhere to the relevant requirements relating to minimum quantity, and other relevant requirements detailed in the general requirements above. The calculation and procedure for ascertaining the weight of an individual item used for the calculation must be documented.

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21 Foreign object control, detection and removal

Control of foreign objects reduces the risk of contamination or damage to the products, and subsequent harm to the consumer.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P		O	21.1	Foreign object controls and risk assessment	The site must ensure that potential foreign objects in production/packing areas are minimised. Where this is not possible, the site must have a documented risk assessment and corresponding effective controls in place. Where any potential foreign object is used in the process or integral to the product (for example, bamboo canes) and/or packaging and/or distribution trays/crates (for example staples, clips) it must be suitably controlled to prevent contamination. Product packaging or distribution trays/crates etc. must not be used to store other materials (for example, nuts, bolts, tools, chemicals).
	R		21.2	Foreign object investigation	When a foreign object is identified or detected, the source of the material must be fully investigated. Where possible this investigation must be used to instigate corrective and preventative action to reduce the likelihood of re-occurrence of the contamination. Records of any investigation must be kept.
		O	21.3	Glass, ceramics and hard plastics	Where glass (including windows and equipment), ceramics and/or hard plastics that pose a risk to product in production/packing and storage areas, controls must be in place to prevent or identify potential contamination. All items that pose a risk to product must be identified.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		21.4	Glass, ceramics and hard plastic audits	Where audits are carried out on glass, ceramics and/or hard plastics, audits must be completed at a frequency determined by risk assessment. The audit must record any changes in condition of the items. Where repairs are needed a plan must be put in place to complete this work and a risk assessment must be completed to determine how quickly repairs must be made. Any issues raised must be investigated to establish if the glass breakage procedure has been followed and whether the product has been put at risk. If product is likely to have been contaminated the incident management procedure must be instigated.
		O	21.5	Glass, ceramics and hard plastic breakage	A procedure must be in place for the management of glass, ceramics and hard plastic breakages. Breakage procedures must include, as a minimum: • stopping of production/packing operations and restriction of movement through the affected area • quarantine of affected materials • report to management • clean up of breakage and disposal/cleaning of cleaning equipment • safe removal of broken material from area • repair or replacement of damaged item • the checking of workwear (including footwear) and changing if necessary • completion of an incident log and sign off that packing can restart • a sample of broken material is retained in a safe manner • corrective action to prevent re-occurrence Any equipment used to clean up glass breakage must be disposed of afterwards, unless it is only used for breakage clean-up.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		21.6	Sharps	The site must have sharp metal implement controls in place. These must cover knives, blades, scissors and other metal equipment. The controls must include, as a minimum, where relevant: • only site issued sharps in use • controlled knives, blades and scissors are uniquely identified • no snap blades • knives and blades must only be used for the task for which they were designed • sharps must be accounted for and the condition checked and recorded (start and end of production/packing as a minimum) • blade changes must be recorded • storage for knives and blades used for product processing must be controlled • knife and blade sharpening must take place away from production/packing areas and equipment must be returned in a clean condition • sharps must not be permitted in personal lockers • in the event of breakage or loss, all parts must be accounted for and the incident logged. Corrective action must be taken to prevent re-occurrence • in the event of breakage or loss a system must be in place to identify and control potentially contaminated product

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22 Inspection and analysis

Product inspection and analysis demonstrate that products meet safety and legality requirements and comply with the Tesco specification

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		22.1	Laboratories	External laboratories and their testing methods must be accredited by their country national accreditation body, an internationally recognised country body or hold industry accreditation. Routine quality control checks which are completed in an on-site laboratory environment such as measuring, quality sampling etc. do not need laboratory accreditation.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	22.2	Non-conforming products	Non-conforming product, rejects and returns that present a risk of contamination shall be identified, labelled and stored in a way that prevents contamination of other products. All other non-conforming products must be segregated from other product. If the finished product deviates from the agreed specification the Tesco Technical contact must be notified and the product must be quarantined pending risk assessment. Tesco must be notified immediately of any illegal, unsafe or otherwise non-conforming products which have been despatched. If raw materials, finished product or process deviates from specification or set procedures, then root cause analysis and corrective actions must be taken and documented. Potential trends must be identified and corrective actions must be carried out based on the product non-conformances.
P	R		22.3	Reporting, monitoring and trending results	Procedures must be in place for reporting of testing results, monitoring compliance to specification and where applicable trend analysis to identify issues and their severities which are increasing. The procedures must include what action and investigation is required in the event of out of specification results.

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23 Transport

Management of transport providers and vehicles ensures that products are protected during transport and that the risk of contamination or damage to the product is reduced.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R	O	23.1	Transport	All vehicles used for transportation must be maintained in a condition that ensures the safety, legality and quality of materials is not compromised. Procedures must be in place to minimise the risk of contamination during transportation and ensure product is transported as per the product specification.
	R		23.2	Third parties	Where any third party transport is used, it must comply with all relevant requirements in this Standard and must be defined within a contract of Service Level Agreement (SLA) and effectively managed.
P		O	23.3	Loading and unloading	Where materials are susceptible to weather damage, pests and/or foreign object contamination (for example, dust, leaves), vehicles must be loaded and unloaded in covered bays or the materials suitably protected.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		23.4	Temperature control	Where materials require temperature control, they must be loaded and unloaded in a way that does not affect product quality. Where temperature-controlled transport is required, documented procedures must be in place to ensure the temperature requirements are met. Transport must be capable of maintaining product temperature within specification, under maximum load. Procedures must be in place in case of breakdown of vehicle refrigeration.
P			23.5	Security	Procedures must be in place to ensure product is held under secure conditions during transport.

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Complaints, withdrawal, recall and incident management

24

Investigation and analysis of customer complaints can improve product quality, supports continuous improvement and can prevent minor issues progressing into major incidents, which can affect consumer trust, as well as put them at risk. Effective management of emergency situations enables appropriate decisions and communications to be made, resulting in the protection of consumers, the product and business continuity.

P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		24.1	Complaint handling procedure	A complaints policy and procedure must be in place This must be part of the site incident management procedures, depending on complaint severity. All complaints must be captured on a record and be given a unique reference. The record must include as a minimum: • the product information • the nature of the complaint • the method of reporting (for example, phone, email, media) Complaints from all sources must be covered in the procedure. These must include as a minimum: • customer representatives (for example, technical managers, buyers, support office) • stores (store returns, distribution centre rejections) • retailer customer complaints departments • law enforcement bodies • output from internal or customer quality assurance processes for example, testing panels • site internal departments (for example, operational departments) The complaint handling procedure must identify what steps are taken depending on the type of complaint, for example, foreign object, quality.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		24.2	Complaint investigation	All complaints must be investigated. The investigation must determine whether the complaint is product specific (isolated) or is an issue which is likely to affect more than one product. Full records must be kept and the outcome of the investigation promptly reported to relevant personnel and departments. Corrective actions must be effective to prevent a re-occurrence. Mechanisms must be in place for briefing corrective action with the relevant departments. Where requested the full corrective actions must be reported to Tesco.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		24.3	Complaint monitoring and trend analysis	Complaint levels, severities and trends must be monitored. If there is an increase in the severity or number of complaints, an investigation must be carried out. Information from trend analysis of complaints must be communicated to the site management, production teams and the Tesco Technical contact. If complaints are received on other brands produced/packed by the site, and the issue could affect the safety or legality of Tesco product, the site must report the issue to Tesco.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P			24.4	Incident management	Any issue that could affect supply or Tesco brand integrity must be reported to Tesco. Procedures must be in place to manage all incidents and potential emerging issues which could affect product safety, legality and quality. The procedures must include a defined incident management team. Procedures must include the following, as a minimum: • disruptions to operations and distribution, water and energy supplies, labour and communications including digital security • fire, flood and other natural disasters • sabotage and malicious contamination • vandalism and terrorism • product safety, legality and quality issues The likelihood of the occurrence of the identified issues must be risk assessed. A communication plan must be in place to manage potential incidents. If a non-manufacturing supplier or supplier deals with Tesco on behalf of the manufacturing site, the agent or supplier must have procedures to manage emergency situations. There must be no delay in providing information to Tesco as a result of this being completed via an intermediary.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
	R		24.5	Contacts	Key contact information must be maintained. Contact information (both working hours and emergency out of hours) must include the following, as a minimum: • internal contacts • Tesco or Supplier • suppliers of raw materials and services • local government and enforcement bodies • site management • Any issue that impacts on supply or affects the brand integrity must be reported to Tesco.

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P	R	O	Clause number	Topic	Requirements
P	R		24.6	Withdrawal and recall plans	The site must have a system in place to enable the effective withdrawal and recall of products should this be required (for example, where safety, legality or quality is in doubt or there is a reputational risk). The procedure must include, as a minimum: • how to report an incident to Tesco • the full process of traceability identifying key points in production/packing and distribution • how product will be withdrawn or recalled from distribution and sale All affected products must be located within 2 hours of the withdrawal/recall being started. Reconciliation of product must be verified against production/packing records. The withdrawal/recall of Tesco brand products from Tesco stores will be managed by Tesco. Any communication with external bodies, Government or enforcement agencies, regarding Tesco branded products must be co-ordinated by Tesco.
P	R		24.7	Mock recall and incident management	A Tesco specific mock recall (or mock incident) must be undertaken by the site to test the effectiveness of the system and the incident management team's understanding of the recall procedures. The test must occur annually as a minimum, during production/packing, and takes into account seasonal products or processes. Out of office hours tests must occur at least every 2 years, and reflect reduced management staff levels on site. There must be documented evidence that all aspects of a recall have been undertaken.

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Glossary

Acronym	Definition
Contingency supplier	When, due to unforeseen and/or unavoidable circumstances, an alternative supplier must be used on a short-term, temporary basis.
Controlled waste	Waste that is subject to legislative control in either its handling or its disposal
EFK	Electric Fly Killer
EPW	Emergency Product Withdrawal – when Tesco has to remove all/full batch of product from our stores
ETI	Ethical Trading Initiative
FEFO	First Expiry – First Out
FIFO	First In – First Out
First party audit	An audit conducted by or on behalf of the production site, at a raw material supplier site e.g. ingredient supplier.
GLAA	Gangmasters & Labour Abuse Authority – Investigate agency for labour exploitation in the UK
HACCP	Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Point
ISO 14001-2015	An International Organisation for Standardisation that specifies requirements for a framework that can be employed to establish an effective Environmental Management System (EMS).
MSDS	Material Safety Data Sheet
NGO	Non-Governmental Organisation
Non-Manufacturing Supplier	An organisation that trades between other organisations, but never purchases or 'owns' the items they are trading, or an organisation that purchases or 'owns' items for re-sale.
OHAS	Ornamental Horticulture Assurance Scheme
PPM	Planned Preventative Maintenance
Primary packaging	The product packaging the final consumer disposes of, for example, product label, container

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Protector Line	A telephone and email service, which allows colleagues, suppliers and their staff to disclose information that relates to suspected wrongdoing or dangers at work relating to Tesco
QMS	Quality Management System
Recall	When Tesco has to notify customers of a product issue and ask them to return the item urgently
Second party audit	An audit conducted by or on behalf of Tesco, at a production site
SEDEX	Supplier Ethical Data Exchange
Service Provider	An organisation that provides product assurance services on behalf of Tesco
Sharps	Implements used for cutting or piercing e.g. knife, needle, scissors and blades
SIZA	Sustainability Initiative of South Africa
SMETA	SEDEX Members Ethical Trade Audit – a set of ethical protocols for audits.
Surplus stock	Excess product that conforms to all specification requirements apart from meeting minimum shelf/vase life requirements for delivery to Tesco
Tesco Due Diligence Platform	TQC or myProduct: Inspectorio Compliance
Third party audit	An audit conducted by an auditing company against a recognised industry standard, e.g. - OHAS
TQC	Tesco Quality Connect – Tesco due diligence database
Whistle-blower	A person who exposes misconduct, alleged dishonest or illegal activity
WIP	Work In Progress
Workwear	Clothing, footwear and Personal Protective Equipment worn by employees and visitors in production/packing and storage areas.

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Revision history and key changes

Date issued	Version	Document Section	Change Summary
Jan 2022	4.0	Full review of standard	• Change from BRAG to numbered grading and definitions • Segregation Module has now been incorporated • Sections 1 & 2 now always in scope • Inclusion of culture clauses in section 1 • Updated Responsible Sourcing section due to change in Human Rights and Protector Line Requirements • Merging of several clauses and or moved to more appropriate sections of the standard. • Additions to some clauses for further clarity • Updated Pest Management section. • Added statement in respect of equipment manufacturers and providers giving misleading endorsement to introduction.
April 2026	5.0	Full review of standard	• Updated section - Auding of Standard • 4.6 Additional clause – peat usage • 6.10 Addition of the requirement for the Food Experts for PPPL's • 8.4 Point 5 of the procedures. Change to wording to remove the term microbiologically and replace with chemically disinfected • 10.6 Live catch and breakback traps monitoring, addition of remotely connected systems • 13.3 Wording of risk assessment for the wearing of jewellery updated to link to site policy • 15 Overview section. Removal of the word food • 19.1 Added Plant Passports and Phytosanitary Certificates • 11 Overview section. Removal of the word food. **Glossary** • change to Third Party Audit to remove BOPP and replace with OHAS • Removal of SA8000, TNE & BRAG

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